

Jude D. Edelman

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Research Statement

I study how institutions sort people into unequal life trajectories in ways that appear natural but are produced through the concentration and exercise of power. My work examines child welfare systems and postsecondary education as sites where resources flow into institutional structures and are converted into classificatory logics that generate durable inequalities for the populations moving through them. Across these projects, I ask how institutions come to treat certain outcomes as acceptable losses rather than failures of design, and what it would mean to take seriously that the sorting was never inevitable.

Education

PhD, Sociology 2025–Present
Florida State University

BS, Psychology (with honors) 2025
Florida State University – *Magna Cum Laude*
Honors Thesis: Does Perceived Harm Depend on the Race of the Agent
Mentored by Dr. David March, FSU

BS, Sociology 2025
Florida State University – *Magna Cum Laude*

Research and Teaching Interests

Social Stratification & Mobility · (Critical) (Race) Theory · Education & Labor · Epistemology
· Child Welfare & Youth Development · Rural Studies

Works in Progress

Moss-Pech, C.[†] & **Edelman, J.D.** “College Skill-use and Employment Experiences Four Years after Graduation.” *Manuscript in preparation*.

Edelman, J.D., “Fostering Inequality: How Privatization Policy Has Differential Impact Across Geographic Space.” *Manuscript in preparation*.

Edelman, J.D., & Buggs, S. “The Converging Language of an Unconverging Debate: Conservative and Abolitionist Discourse in U.S. Child Welfare Reform.” *Data analysis phase*.

[†] denotes equal authorship

Selected Presentations

Forthcoming

“College Skill-use and Employment Experiences Four Years after Graduation,” *American Educational Research Association*, April 14, 2027.

“Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Different Groups’ Mobility Outcomes,” *Association for Interdisciplinary Studies*, Panama City, FL, November 9, 2026.

“Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Rural and Urban Mobility Outcomes,” *Southern Demographic Association*, Austin, TX, October 7, 2026.

Completed

“Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Rural and Urban Mobility Outcomes,” *Annual Meeting of the Rural Sociological Society*, Raleigh, NC, August 1, 2026.

Invited Talks

“Same Shock, Different Story: Race and the Social Construction of Pain,” *Howard Baker Research Talk*, FSU Department of Psychology, April 25, 2024.

“How Pain Perception is Moderated by Race of the Aggressor,” March Labs, FSU (virtual), March 17, 2024.

Funding and Awards

Sara Miller McCune Scholarship for ICPSR	\$5,000
Charles B. Nam Fellowship Fund Travel Award (August 2026)	\$1,000
Association for Interdisciplinary Studies Travel Award (November 2026)	\$675
College of Graduate Students Travel Grant	\$200
Outstanding Graduate Student Service Award, Sociology Graduate Student Union	2026

Applied Service

Community Impact Panelist , Children’s Services Council of Leon County	2026
Worked cooperatively to oversee the distribution of a \$2.7 million budget to community-based OST programs and presented recommendations to the board.	

Wish Upon a Star Volunteer Coordinator , Partnership for Strong Families	2025
Oversaw the distribution of holiday presents to hundreds of children in the child welfare system in North Central Florida.	

Professional Activities and Service

Rural Sociological Society, Member	2026–Present
American Sociological Association, Member	2025–Present
Sociology Graduate Student Union, Working Group Organizer	2025–Present
Graduate Assistants Union, Member	2025–Present
Association for Interdisciplinary Studies, Member	2026–Present
Southern Demographic Association, Member	2026–Present

Research Experience

Research Assistant , March Lab – Threat Perception and Cognition Florida State University, PI: D. March	2021–2025
Research Assistant , Sub-Saharan Africa Maternal Health Lab Florida State University, PI: K. Davis	2025–Present

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

Sex and Gender (undergraduate, virtual)	Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Summer 2026
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